

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarethpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



EARTHEN RESOLVE

In Chennai, an enterprise focussed on making curd pots has completed its golden jubilee due to a man who would not give up. This enterprise is as small as it gets; it has two members on its rolls, he and his wife **P4**



The dry waste collection drive near you

Meet three Chennai residents who have brought the healthy practice of squirrelling away dry discards for the recycler to their neighbourhood and also made it regular. These initiatives are having a buy-in from their neighbours **P6**

Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar residents irked by lack of sewer drains

Residents have been seeking this facility for over a decade. Many let out sewage into Puzhal lake through illegal connections



A street at Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar on June 28, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

tan Water Supply & Sewerage Board, Greater Chennai Corporation, and elected representatives for nearly a decade but the efforts have been in vain.

“Over the years, the authorities have been citing fund crunch. Due to the lack of underground sewage drains, a considerable number of residents let out sewage through illegal connections to the nearby Puzhal lake. People resort to this reckless disposal of sewage in order to avoid the expenditure of clearing their septic tanks. Sewage overflowing on the road is a common sight at Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar and it is horrible during rains,” says C.H. Balaji, secretary of Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar Residents Welfare Association. The association also points out the need for stormwater drains.

“There are 13 streets in Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar but only one street has got this facility. This is a low-lying area and therefore prone to water stagnation. Further, it is time to relaid the roads as they were last relaid around five years ago. Most of the roads are battered. However, stormwater drains and sewage drains should be first established. Otherwise the road work will be a pointless exercise,” adds Balaji.

A Greater Chennai Corporation official says, “A cut-and-cover drain connecting Manal Odai and Puzhal lake was constructed last year. Soon, SWDs will be constructed in other streets. During the last week’s rains, GCC took remedial measures immediately to drain the water.”

L. KANTHIMATHI

Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar in Ambattur witnessed heavy waterlogging following the rains last week. The stagnant water was mixed with sewage, says Padmavathi Srinivasan Nagar Residents Welfare Association.

Residents are irked by the lack of an underground sewage drainage system and a stormwater drainage system.

The association notes that along with United Welfare Associations - Ambattur, a federation of residents associations in Ambattur, it has been seeking these facilities with Chennai Metropolitan Corporation.



Annettes come to the fore in Anna Nagar

As its debut project, the Annette Club of United Chennai will start a weekend fundraising campaign to support local orphanages

On July 4, the Rotary Club of United Chennai has officially chartered the Annette Club of United Chennai, at a function at the Towers Club in Anna Nagar, which also saw the installation of the Club’s 12th President, Rtn. Manikandan.K, alongside incoming Secretary Rtn. Raghuvarman .E and the new board of directors, says a press release.

Designed specifically for the children of active Rotary members, the Annette Club provides a framework for young people to develop early leadership skills, elect their own youth board, and manage independent service initiatives.

According to the release, Annette Mithuksha Arulkanth was collared as the historical Charter President, alongside Charter Secretary Annette Zayn Basha and a newly formed 12-member youth board.

Demonstrating immediate initiative,

the Annette Club announced its very first service project: a weekend fundraising campaign to support local orphanages. The youth members plan to set up fresh juice stalls at popular public parks and vantage spots across Chennai on weekends. One hundred percent of the proceeds will be used to purchase essential groceries, supplies, and clothing for orphanage inmates.

The young leaders bring a diverse set of talents to their new roles. Charter President Mithuksha, a 6th-grade student at Vedanta Academy in Vanagaram, is an accomplished Bharatanatyam dancer and keyboardist. Charter Secretary Zayn Basha, a 6th-grade student at LM Dadha in Choolaimedu, is a dedicated badminton player with a strong passion for drawing.

The function was held in the presence of Chief Guest Rtn. Shriram Duvvuri, Rotary District Governor for International District 3233. Joining him as guests of honour were Rtn. D. Devendran, Immediate Past District Governor, and Mr. S. Venkatesh, Senior HR Leader & Advisor at Sanmar Group, Chennai. The ceremony also featured a special appearance by past District Governor and Kalaimamani recipient, Rtn. Abirami Ramanathan.

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Loco Scheme Second Street.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Pedestrian space usurped’

C S VIKGNESH KUMAR

The Perambur Loco Works railway station has a parking lot for two-wheelers. But most of the commuters park their vehicles along the nearby Loco Scheme Second Street. Both sides of the roads are usurped. Pedestrians are forced to walk on the middle of the road. This hinders traffic flow during peak hours especially for motorists moving towards Periyar Nagar via Loco Bridge.

C. S. Vikgnesh Kumar is a resident of Periyar Nagar

‘Sewage overflow, a perennial issue in East Gopalapuram’



Fourth Main Road at East Gopalapuram in Pattabiram.

C. SRIDHAR KUMAR

Sewage overflow has become a recurrent issue on Fourth Main Road in East Gopalapuram in Pattabiram in the last one year. Almost every day, sewage



PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

is overflowing. Complaints to Avadi Corporation did not yield the desired result.

C. Sridhar Kumar, a commuter and a representative of Pattabiram Gopalapuram Makkal Seva Sangam, a residents welfare association.

‘Electricity cable work incomplete at SIDCO Nagar’



SIDCO Nagar in Villivakkam.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

M. SENTHIL

Work on providing underground electricity cables began at SIDCO Nagar in Villivakkam around three years ago. There are close to 95 streets at SIDCO Nagar but only around 15 streets have got this facility. The work remains incomplete to this day.

M. Senthil is a resident of Villivakkam

Passenger amenities are unsatisfactory at Thirunindravur railway station



Most of the seats are broken at Thirunindravur railway station. Besides, they are installed at a very low level making it quite inconvenient for commuters especially senior citizens. Further, the existing number of seats is not adequate.

Electricity cables are exposed at platforms three and four raising the risk of accidents.

The pay-and-use public toilet near the booking office is not kept open round-the-clock. Besides, it is unhygienic. Citing renovation, the toilet on platform three was locked a few months ago but the work has not started to this day. The number of public toilets needs to be increased at the station.

Further, the station lacks CCTV



cameras near its entrance from CTH Road and at the booking office.

New shelters were installed at the platforms at Thirunindravur railway station a few years ago but they lack seats and fans. Further, the shelters on platform three are broken and leaks water during rain. An old shelter on platform one is rusted and metal rods are ex-

Thirunindravur railway station.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

posed. The waiting hall needs to be revamped.

An old and dilapidated building on platform three needs to be demolished as it poses a hindrance to commuters while boarding and alighting the train. There have been a few instances where people have hit the building and got injured.

The office of the signal panel was housed in this building but it was shifted to a new building on platform five in November last year.

S. Murugaiyan is the president of Thirunindravur Rail Passengers Welfare Association.

‘This electricity box in Kilpauk is unsafe’

D. RADHAKRISHNAN

The electricity junction box on Medavakkam Tank Road in Kilpauk, near TNSC Bank - Kellys branch, is unsafe. The box got damaged this February during stormwater drain construction. Complaints to Greater Chennai Corporation were to no avail. It may be noted its cables are exposed and raises the risk of untoward incidents.

D. Radhakrishnan is a resident of Kilpauk

The image was taken on July 3, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



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Weekend Spotlight

Anna Nagar: Where Aspirations Meet Opportunity

From financial security to dream homes, grand weddings, and timeless textiles, Anna Nagar continues to shape the aspirations and lifestyles of modern Chennai families.

Haarshini Agarwal

Over the years, has transformed into more than just one of Chennai's most established residential neighborhoods'. It has become a thriving ecosystem where life's biggest milestones, from weddings and home ownership to wealth creation and lifestyle choices, seamlessly come together.

For many families in Anna Nagar, financial planning has become a crucial part of shaping the future. With rising awareness around investments, retirement planning, and wealth management, residents are increasingly seeking expert guidance



ance to make informed financial decisions. Whether it is planning for a child's education, a dream wedding, or long-term security, structured financial planning is helping families stay prepared.

Weddings continue to hold a special place in the community, with Anna Nagar emerging as a preferred hub for wedding shopping and services. From bridal consultations to curated

celebrations, families are looking for experiences that combine tradition with convenience. This growing demand has naturally strengthened allied sectors like textiles, where craftsmanship and design remain central to every celebration.

Textiles continue to thrive in the locality, reflecting the city's enduring connection to culture and fashion. From festive wear to bespoke fabrics, the market caters to changing tastes while preserving traditional aesthetics.

At the same time, Anna Nagar's strong real estate value continues to make it one of the most sought-after localities in Chennai. With its established

infrastructure, accessibility, educational institutions, and lifestyle conveniences, it remains an attractive destination for both homebuyers and investors.

Together, these sectors reflect the pulse of Anna Nagar, a locality where aspirations are not just imagined, but built, celebrated, and sustained through every stage of life.



ZARIA SILKS ANNOUNCES MEGA SALE IN MOGAPPAIR

Zaria Silks, a highly rated premium destination for women's fashion, has announced a massive flat-50%-off special sale from July 4 to 6. Renowned for its exceptional customer service and a near-perfect 4.9-star Google rating, the showroom offers an extensive, unmatched collection of traditional sarees, elegant salwars, trendy kurtis, and chic co-ord sets. Conveniently located in Mogappair East, the store has earned glowing customer feedback for combining high-quality fabrics with remarkably affordable prices. Fashion enthusiasts can explore an incredible variety of everyday and celebratory wear during this limited three-day shopping extravaganza.

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S.Ramalingam has received the **TIMES OF INDIA TRAILBLAZERS OF TAMILNADU AWARD 2026** from Thiru. Dr. K.G.Arun Raj Hon'ble Minister of Health, Medical Education, and Family Welfare, Government of Tamil Nadu.

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Earthen resolve

In Chennai, an enterprise focussed on making curd pots has completed its golden jubilee due to a man who would not give up. This enterprise is as small as it gets; it has two members on its rolls, he and his wife



▼ A whirlwind tour of the curd pot making unit at Royapettah; the people in the images are K. Manohar and M. Bhuvaneshwari.

PHOTOS: R. RAGU

drying the pots and firing them. He makes these pots with clay sourced from Red Hills. Every day, he manages to make 200-300 pots; after he has racked up around 2,000 pots, he initiates the firing process.

He maintains an inventory of 4000 pots at any point in time. Though not extremely keen on retailing, he does not shy away from it either. The pots are priced in the range of ₹8 to ₹10 each. He is content servicing that one bulk order, one that keeps him busy.

The address he operates from was apparently originally called Royapettah-Kosapet for its association with the making of clay pots and lamps. It was subsequently changed to Maavadi Vinayagar Koil Street. His workspace comes at a rent of ₹5000 per month; and the demand for firewood having gone up partly during the time there was a gripping fear of LPG shortage and not climbing down, his pot-making costs have gone up.

When he fires a batch of pots, he faces protest from neighbours on account of the smoke the process generates. To avoid friction with the neighbours, he restricts pot-firing to one day in a week, that too on a week day, so that when the process takes place, most residents are away, at their workplaces, schools and colleges. Manohar can be reached at 9790843188

Every day, he manages to make 200-300 pots; after he has racked up around 2,000 pots, he initiates the firing process

A LONG INNINGS

is a column about enterprises in Chennai that have successfully dodged the curveballs of time often with plain grit and nothing else



R. RAGU

A resident of Maavadi Vinayagar Koil Street at Balaji Nagar in Royapettah, K. Manohar has been in the business of making small curd pots (*dahi handi*). Having seen 65 summers, Manohar has witnessed the vicissitudes of time, as has his business alongside him, which is obviously younger than him but not significantly. The business keeps “firing”, showing no signs of ageing; it is 50 years old.

There are challenges, but Manohar has soldiered on, watching his

business outlive even star hotels that once placed huge orders with him but have since slipped into oblivion.

As things stand, he supplies these pots to one star hotel in Chennai, the enterprise attracted to his creations for the novelty they bring to the table.

He functions with a two-member team, that is, if one counts him in. The only other team member is also his partner for life, M. Bhuvaneshwari his wife: talk about family-run business!

She chips in by helping him with preparations for processes such as

At the Oncology Kitchen at ICH, Egmore; and (below) the caretaker of a child undergoing treatment at ICH registering as part of the process to take food from the Oncology Kitchen to the child.



A worry taken off their plate

Oncology Kitchen at the Institute of Child Health and Hospital for Children in Egmore meets the huge nutritional needs of children undergoing cancer treatment. And the fact that the bill of fare comes free is a huge relief to their parents

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Malnutrition is cancer's wingman with a cruiser-ready shotgun. Cancer is formidable enough without this companion-in-arms by its side; and when the two team up, a two-front war is a necessity. At the government-run Institute of Child Health and Hospital for Children (ICH) in Egmore, oncologists and social workers are engaged in such a war, the former treating the children at the cancer ward and the latter, treating them to eats, as nourishing as they are tasty, at a unique kitchen.

It is called "Oncology Kitchen", clearly the rarest of rare lexical pairs. But this one enjoys easy familiarity with the tongues of its beneficiaries (at any given time around 50 children undergoing cancer treatment at ICH as well as a few children being treated for thalassemia) because from Monday to Saturday, between 10 a.m. and 11 a.m., the aroma of health food tas-

tily done wafts out of this kitchen and heads to the beds at the cancer ward. The caretaker of a child registers and takes the food to the ward. Children who are not weak might tag along with their caretakers, and following registration, have the food in the kitchen.

G.V. Williams, founder of the voluntary organisation Myrtle Social Welfare Network, which runs the Oncology Kitchen at ICH, notes this kitchen is hardly an add-on service, but one integral to cancer treatment which often causes severe weight loss and declining blood counts and ups nutritional demands significantly. Oncology Kitchen programme coordinator Tryphosa Mavis recalls the story of Devayani (name changed), a child diagnosed with blood cancer and who following treatment, was reduced to skin

COLLECTIVE KINDNESS
is a column about efforts by voluntary agencies and individual volunteers shoring up strikingly direct and noticeable initiatives by government agencies to serve the underprivileged sections of society



and bones. With proper nutrition and care from the Oncology Kitchen, she improved, gaining the necessary weight and showing adequately increased blood levels. Today, she visits the hospital only for monthly follow-ups, and has become an icon of hope for parents whose children are facing similar weight loss. Seeing Devayani, they know their child

too need not stay emaciated on account of cancer treatment.

The kitchen offers another balm to parents; in fact a cure, ridding them of the anxiety of having to provide their children up against cancer with nutritious food; it takes that worry off their plate.

Everything on the bill of fare at the Oncology Kitchen is free of cost. It was with this dual aim the Oncology Kitchen was launched at ICH on April 18, 2024, says Wil-

liams.

He rattles off the usual contents of the menu: rice porridge, health mix, cut fruits, milk, boiled eggs and sprouts. In addition, the kitchen offers customised meals. He elaborates that some children require to be on a specialised diet plan based on their condition and treatment and the preparation in the kitchen follows the food prescriptions written out by the oncologist. The kitchen serves 300 to 360 meals every week, with the total weekly cost ranging between ₹40,000 and ₹50,000. Among Myrtle's plans for the future is increasing the offering to three meals a day.

A close encounter

The inspiration to start Oncology Kitchen dates back to 2015, when Williams saw his friend lose his daughter to cancer; the girl was struck in the prime of her life, being just 20 years old at the time of death. Before her death, she wished that no child suffering from cancer should be left uncared for; even when facing the inevitable, her voice only reflected compassion, recalls Williams.

The kitchen is one of the outcomes of a memorandum of understanding Myrtle Social Welfare Network signed with ICH to support the children undergoing cancer treatment at the hospital and their parents in various ways. Besides seeking to keep these children in good health through the Oncology Kitchen, the voluntary organisation keeps them in good cheer through activities (for a sense of what they do at ICH), check out their Insta page @myrtle_social_welfare_network.

Notable ways in which secondary support shows up include: one, recognising that siblings are often neglected during a medical crisis, it provides educational support for them. It further conducts monthly parent support meetings where families share experiences, seek guidance and support one another through difficult times, Williams notes.

Among the assurances made to the hospital about the Oncology Kitchen is a commitment to maintaining hygiene and sanitation standards. Overseen by a manager and a supervisor, the kitchen comes with the assurance of FSSAI certification, says Williams.

Williams notes that when the idea of a kitchen of this stripe was up in the air, the hospital authorities and parents gave it a double thumbs up, displaying an unbiased mind. He adds that the government has definitely been benevolent with their constant support.

The NGO meets the expenditure with donations from individuals and organisations. People can also sponsor meals for the children undergoing treatment.

For details about the Oncology Kitchen, contact Myrtle Social Welfare Network at 9840096022.

The *dry waste* collection drive near you



Ashwini H. Pandit at her driveway at Vasudeva Nagar in Thiruvannmiyur

Meet three Chennai residents who have brought the healthy practice of squirrelling away dry discards for the recycler to their neighbourhood and also made it regular. These initiatives are having a buy-in from their neighbours

The initiative, coordinated through the apartment's WhatsApp groups, has also nudged residents towards more mindful disposal practices. Instead of throwing away batteries, keyboards or tube lights, many now message Sreevidhya to ask where they can be responsibly discarded. To Sreevidhya, that change in behaviour is more significant than the volume of waste collected. She believes the foundation for sustainable living must be laid early. "Children should be educated, not just at school, but at home too so they know what can be recycled and why it should never end up as mixed waste," she says.

For details, email sreevidhyaashok03@gmail.com

Make it hyperlocal if you can

G. Saranya is guided by a simple but effective principle: waste should not have to travel farther than the people willing to recycle it. And this belief has led her to facilitate a dry waste collection drive within her sprawling residential community in Pallikaranai.

Having regularly dropped off old clothes, footwear and other household discards at citizen-led collection drives while accompanying her mother for medical appointments, Saranya realised that her own community lacked the avenue for responsible disposal of items such as worn-out school uniforms, tattered clothes, toys and footwear.

Rather than spearheading the initiative herself, Saranya chose to play the role of a facilitator. Recognising the scale of her community, home to more than 2,000 families, she reached out to residents' association members and introduced them to organisers already conducting collection drives across Chennai.

The proposal is now taking shape, with discussions under way to organise a dedicated collection drive within the community. Saranya hopes it will evolve into a regular, neighbourhood-level effort, making responsible disposal as convenient as taking out the household waste. "People do not have time to go somewhere and drop these things. If it is a monthly drive, they will start collecting everything," she says

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

A drive in the driveway

Ashwini H. Pandit's driveway at Vasudeva Nagar in Thiruvannmiyur makes room for unlikely occupants, one Saturday every month: washed milk covers, biscuit wrappers, Tetra Paks, cartons, old clothes and discarded electronics items. They are deposited in the space by neighbours, around 15 of them, who share Ashwini's faith in recycling dry waste.

For a year and half now, Ashwini runs this citizens-led dry waste collection drive. "Garbage all over the city and dirty roads triggered me," she says. "I feel anything can be used. It has a life and should not go into the bin."

The collected waste is passed on to organisations that further segregate it before sending it to recyclers.

For Ashwini, the issue is less about the absence of collection systems and more about everyday habits. "Segregation is the key," she notes. "If everything is mixed, nobody would be willing to do it." She hopes more households will begin with small changes like washing and drying recyclable waste, composting kitchen scraps and carrying reusable bags. "We are not even one percent there yet. We have a

long way to go," says Ashwini.

Residents in and around Thiruvannmiyur can drop off their segregated dry waste at Ashwini's monthly collection drive. For details, call 96633 40341

The power of local engagement

Sreevidhya Ashok, a resident of Vijayanagar in Velachery learnt the ropes of community waste man-

agement with Residents of Kasturbanagar Association (ROKA) volunteering with it for six years, being particularly engaged with its city-wide collection drives. And one day, she decided it was essential to bring the initiative closer, make dry waste collection a monthly, local exercise.

Since last month, Sreevidhya has been hosting a collection every

last Saturday. "People were eagerly waiting for the yearly drive, but they found it difficult to store recyclables for so long," she said. "So we thought, why not conduct it every month?"

The response to the first drive validated the move: nearly 300 kg of material was collected, with reusable items accounting for nearly 70% of the collection.

Other efforts

*At Raja Street, Mandaveli, a fortnightly dry waste collection drive is conducted in collaboration with Kabadiwalla Connect; it takes place on a Saturday. For details about nearby drop-off points, call 99400 56069

*Founder of Zero Waste Initiatives at Boutique Bougainvillea in Velachery, Sherin Joseph conducts a monthly waste collection drive every fourth Sunday (2 to 5 p.m.) since January 2025. For details, call 98410 75367

* At RK Nagara in Mandaveli, a community-led waste collection initiative has been running for the past 7-8 years, organised in collaboration with recycling partners. It is held once every 4-5 months. For details, call 70108 48668

* Citizen-led waste management initiatives in MRC Nagar have been active since 2013, dry waste collection drives are conducted once or twice a year, with designated building-level collection points like gyms and common rooms used for drop-offs. For details, call 96000 47586



The shed at Valmiki Nagar to collect dry waste

* A shed installed in Valmiki Nagar nearly seven years ago has been repurposed as a community drop-off point since the first waste collection drive was organised in August 2021. For the past two years, collection drives have been held once every three months, from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m. For details, call 98402 04192

Academician honoured for 50 years of social service



'Naasey' J. Ramachandran, founder of Naasey Charitable Trust and chancellor of AMET University, was recently honoured for completing 50 years in social service.

Rajesh Ramachandran, president of AMET University, delivered the welcome address and launched a documentary chronicling the academician's decades of social service, youth empowerment, employment generation, and community development.

The programme saw eminent personalities from public life, academia, and politics who felicitated Ramachandran for his

contributions.

Parveen Sultana, an orator, lauded Ramachandran's lifelong commitment to social service and his sustained efforts to empower youth, create livelihood opportunities, and establish institutions that have benefited society across diverse sectors.

J.C.D. Prabhakar, Speaker, Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, described Ramachandran as a humanitarian who dedicated himself to serving society even before achieving personal success.

Su. Thirunavukkarasar, former Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president, recalled his long association with Ramachandran and traced his inspiring journey from Valudavur village in Villupuram district to becoming an internationally recognized educationist.

"His initiatives have benefited nearly 2.5 lakh families, impacting close to one million people,"

J.C.D. Prabhakar, Speaker, Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, honouring J. Ramachandran at the felicitation ceremony.

PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Students go on a twisting spree



Chettinad Vidyashram observed International Yoga Day on the theme 'Sarvam Yoga Mayam' during the morning assembly on June 20. Sudama Vipra Das, vice president of ISKCON, graced the event.

S. Amudha Lakshmi, principal, emphasised the role of yoga in nurturing discipline, focus and physical fitness.

More than 100 students presented a

mass demonstration of various asanas and breathing exercises at the event conducted by the Yoga department. A few solo performers also demonstrated advanced asanas, highlighting their flexibility, focus, and confidence, said a release.

Vipra Das discussed the significance of yoga and encouraged students to embrace it as a lifelong practice to maintain a healthy, balanced life.

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Workshop on making pickles

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a culinary workshop on making pickles on July 9. Another workshop on making ice-creams from millets will be held on July 10. Both the sessions will be held at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048

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Trust in Villivakkam *looking for mentors*

The non-profit is currently mentoring 200 girls from villages

Surabi Charitable Trust, a philanthropic organisation located in Villivakkam, is looking for female volunteers who can mentor young tribal girls.

The Trust is currently supporting 200 rural girls from Kalvarayan hills, Javvadu hills, Gudalur hills, Dharamapuri, Krishnagiri, Ariya-

lur, Cuddalore, Erode and Kanyakumari under an academic support programme called "Maithreyi". The programme aims to empower these young girls by ensuring they complete their graduation.

Mentors have to speak to the girl students and motivate them to study well. One is required to give pep talks on the phone, and handhold

the student till they complete the academic year or graduation. Mentors can be anywhere in the world, however they should know to speak Tamil, said a release.

A camp

Recently, a two-day camp was conducted for 41 girls from Javadi Hills, Virudunagar and Kodaikanal at

Padma Sarangapani School, Villivakkam to expose them to new experiences and environments.

They were taken to various sight seeing places in the city including Semmozhi Pooga, Anna Centenary Library, Children's Park, Snake Park and the Marina Beach.

An awareness session about the importance of education was also

conducted with speakers such as Sandhya, secretary of FOARA, Sathish, Sriram from UST Global, Ravisharma, Trustee of Surabi Trust, and Prasanna, founder of the Aramporul Foundation addressing the students.

The girls were also treated to a movie at VR Mall Chennai. For details, visit www.surabitrust.org.

Students learn to stay away from drugs



The Rotary Club of Chennai Saarl inaugurated its flagship project, Siragugal, a drug awareness and prevention initiative, at the Government Higher Secondary School, Banavedu Thottam, Poonamallee, on July 1.

The inaugural ceremony was graced by chief guest Vinod Nair, Director of Youth Service, RI District 3233. The awareness session was delivered by Vi-

dya Hari Iyer, social activist, Psychotherapist and Counselor, and POSH & POCSO Consultant and Trainer.

More than 80 students participated in the interactive session, where they learned about the harmful effects of substance abuse, strategies to resist peer pressure, the importance of making informed life choices, and the need to seek timely support when facing challenges.

Free textbooks for college students

RYA Book Bank starts giving away application forms for its annual book distribution programme

Rajasthan Youth Association (RYA) Book Bank has started giving away application forms for its free textbooks scheme.

Students seeking books for B.Com, B.Com CS, BBM, BBA, B.Com CA, B.Com ISM, B.Sc Mathematics, BCA, B.Sc Computer Science can apply. Engineering students can opt from the second years of BE courses.

The free application form can also be collected from the RYA office at No.4, Atkinson Palace, Jothi Venkatachalam Road, behind Office of Commissioner of Police, Vepery; between 10.30 a.m. and 5.30 p.m. The form can also be downloaded online from www.ryabookbank.com.

Last date to apply is July 20.

For details, call 044-25610978 / Dinesh at 98402 03362



MoU signed to promote research

The Department of Mathematics, S.A. College of Arts & Science, Thiruvarkadu, in association with the Career Development Cell and IQAC, recently signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Nanyang Institute of Management (NIM), Singapore, on the campus.

The MoU aims to promote academic and research collaboration through faculty and student ex-

change, learning opportunities, and the sharing of academic resources.

Raymond Khoo, vice-president, Student Recruitment, Admission and Student Services, and Tanny Htet Htet, deputy director, Student Recruitment and Admission, NIM, conducted an awareness session on higher education opportunities in Singapore.

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